

THE BOARD CONSOLE · SPEC FOR BUILD IN CURSOR · 2 SEPTEMBER 2026

The board should be operated with a thumb, not read like a novel. Rook turns GODS-EYE from a 688-kilobyte document into a queue — review items, call up context, decide on the spot, stage instructions to agents and to people, and release with one logged tap — live, two-way, from a phone.

SPEC 01 · REQUIREMENTS WITH PROVENANCE

Not a dashboard. A gate.

Every requirement is motivated by a named failure already on the record. This table is the contract — anything that serves none of these gets cut.

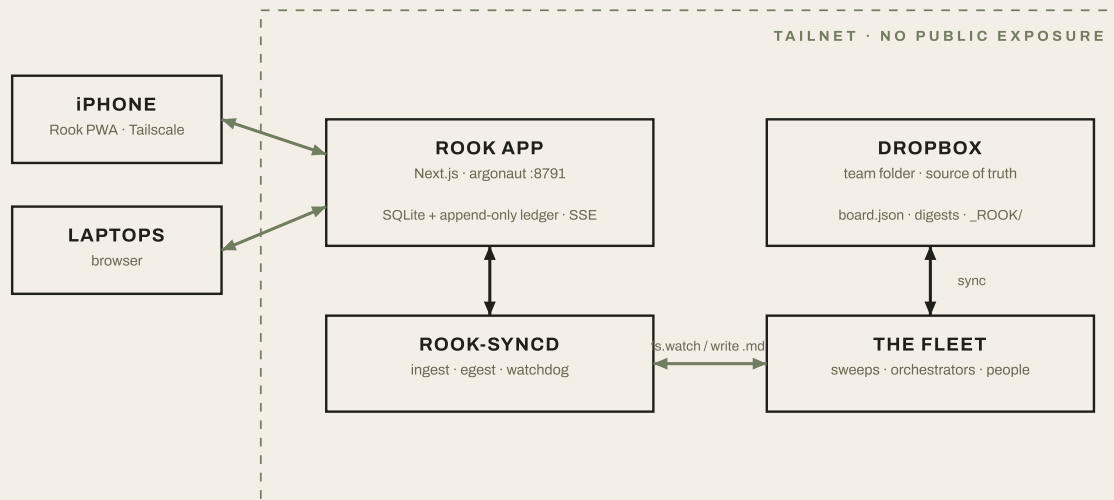
The audit already named the disease: *"no stable decision object"*, an operator wired in as *"the default integration and exception layer,"* and its single most important change — make him an *"explicit material-decision gate."* Rook is that gate, built as an app.

INCIDENT ON THE RECORD	REQUIREMENT IT CREATES
BOARD.md at 688KB — re-ballooned a fortnight after being split to stop "one file eating a third of a context window"	Items live in a database. Markdown becomes a generated view, never the store.
"No stable decision object"; audit confidence on "What did Farhad decide?" — 3/5	A typed, versioned Item with append-only history is the core entity.
"No genuine FM decision recorded since 13 Aug" — later shown to be state-lag: decisions made, recorded late or never	Decisions are captured on the phone at the moment of decision, signed by identity — not reconstructed by a sweep afterwards.
Terra C9: "the machine... rang the bell twice. The decision never came. An alert is not an action."	Deadline items require a decision transition. Undecided criticals escalate — push at T-48h, T-24h, T-3h, each logged.
The standing failure mode: "a completed document waiting on a release decision" — the insurer letter, the Connal instruction, the s357B email drafts	A Dispatch screen: everything staged, one tap to release. Staged-but-unreleased items age visibly and nag daily.
"Whether it was actually sent is NOT recorded" · "machine sends nothing; FM sends"	Release is a first-class event: actor, timestamp, token, proof pointer. Machines never send; Rook stages, a human releases.
The 34-hour launchd outage — "root cause... not further diagnosed"; silence looked like health	A freshness banner on every screen. Staleness > 45 min turns the app amber. The watchdog is independent of the thing it watches.
"Velocity is visible. Closure is not."	Metrics measure the audited interval: raised → decided → released → verified.
"Phone calls are invisible to this machine" · ten of thirteen meeting actions lost to an Otter link	Ten-second voice capture attaches an outcome to an item; a meeting link spawns staged items from the transcript.
Privileged matters + the local-only doctrine ("no cloud host holds the corpus")	Tailnet-only. No cloud. Role-scoped visibility; privileged matters FM-only by default, excluded at the query layer.
The audit's mandated proof pilot: timestamp / actor / transition / proof / verifier	The event ledger stores exactly those five fields on every state change. Rook is the proof pilot.
One failed payment instrument nearly took Workspace, Anthropic, Notion and two debits at once	Rook runs with Google down: Dropbox-file transport for machines; Gmail is an optional channel for people only.

SPEC 02 · ONE SENTENCE, FIVE DECISIONS

The shape of it.

Rook turns the board from a document Farhad reads into a queue Farhad clears – from a phone, with every decision landing back in the canonical record within a minute.



— Five decisions, already made

1 – Host on argonaut. It runs the sweeps and holds the team Dropbox locally. Exposed only via Tailscale (rook.<tailnet>.ts.net, automatic TLS). The phone runs the Tailscale app with on-demand VPN, so the installed PWA feels like a native app. Funnel stays off.

2 – Dropbox stays canonical; SQLite operates. The daemon ingests machine output from the local Dropbox folder – already the fleet's bus – and writes Rook's record back as markdown and JSONL under GODS-EYE/_ROOK/. Any machine, and any future audit, can read it with cat.

3 – Authority migrates in two stages. For 30 days board.json stays authoritative and Rook mirrors it. Only after a clean parallel run – the audit's own pilot standard – does authority invert, BOARD.md becoming a generated view. The inversion is itself an item, decided in Rook, on its own metrics.

4 – Identity is Tailscale. The app reads tailnet identity; a six-row device map binds devices to people. No passwords, nothing to phish, works instantly on the phone. FM sees everything including privileged; Brandon, Zach and Nicki get scoped lanes; machine agents have no UI at all – they speak files.

5 – Reuse, don't rebuild. Mailbox context comes from the existing briefing-room API on 8787; Telegram pings reuse the existing GODS-EYE bot; people-directed emails become gmail_sa drafts for one-tap send. Rook adds no new external surface and calls no LLM – the thinking happens in agent sessions; Rook is deterministic.

EXPLICIT NON-GOALS, V1

Not a chat client, document editor or Gantt tool; not a replacement for the briefings, the Reference Library or the 8787 room. No public exposure, no autonomous sending, no privileged documents in the app – references only, opened in Dropbox. "The next phase is not more reports, more dashboards or more agents." Rook is none of those.

SPEC 03 · DATA MODEL & TWO-WAY SYNC

The decision object, at last.

Six tables. One rule: events are append-only – supersede, never overwrite.

THE STORE (SQLITE · DRIZZLE · ZOD-MIRRORED)	
items	id, legacy id (R-/D-series preserved), kind, matter, lane, title, body, severity, status, owner, due, raised, source ref, privileged flag
context_refs	per-item links — Dropbox paths, Gmail threads, calendar events, pinned quotes with excerpts
amendments	notes, corrections, questions — authored, timestamped, dictation-friendly
dispatches	to agent or person · body · channel · staged → released → acknowledged → done → verified · release token · proof ref
events	timestamp · actor · transition · proof · verifier — the audit's five fields, on every state change
health	last-seen per source: sweep, sync daemon, telemetry, workspace

Item statuses: open → decided → staged → dispatched → acknowledged → done → verified → closed. Nothing is deleted; supersession is a status, and prior text lives in the ledger.

INBOUND · MACHINES → ROOK	
board.json	Upsert items by legacy id – never clobbering fields Rook owns.
digests · agendas	Attach as matter context; feed the Today strip.
run-log tail	Sweep freshness for the health banner.
ack files	Agent acknowledgements flip dispatch state.
OUTBOUND · ROOK → THE FLEET	
_ROOK/decisions/	One markdown file per ruling, five-field frontmatter. Sweeps and Nimbalyst sessions ingest these as rulings – no agent needs new code.
_ROOK/dispatch/agents	Agent construction inboxes. Agents ack by writing a file back. One page added to MODEL-ROUTING doctrine makes every session check its inbox at wake.
people	Scoped Rook view + optional gmail_sa draft for one-tap send + optional Telegram ping. Rook itself never emails anyone.
_ROOK/ledger/	Continuous JSONL mirror of the event ledger + nightly DB snapshot – the record survives any machine.

Six screens, no more.

44-point touch targets, no hover anywhere, dark mode for the 02:54 decisions.

1 · Today — the triage stack.

Freshness banner, then cards hardest-gated first: criticals ≤ 72h, staged-unreleased with age badges, new since last visit. **Swipe right = decide** (dictation-ready note); **swipe left = defer**; **long-press = delegate** to a person or agent. Three actions, one thumb.

2 · Queue — the D-series, operable.

Filter by matter, lane, severity, status, owner. Bulk defer / close / supersede — the "done, drop next sweep" items that haunted the board for a month die here in one gesture.

3 · Item — everything about one thing.

Current statement · pinned context (quotes, Dropbox docs, mailbox excerpts via 8787, the calendar entry) · the human-readable event ledger · amendments with voice capture · actions: decide, amend, stage dispatch, link context, **mark verified** — which demands a proof reference.

4 · Dispatch — the heart of it.

Two tabs. *Staged*: everything awaiting release, grouped by recipient, each with an age badge and a Release button — FM only, token written, channel fired. *In flight*: released items awaiting ack, done, verify; overdue acks flagged. This screen is the direct fix for "a completed document waiting on a release decision."

5 · Matters — the fronts at a glance.

One card per front: status line, next hard date, output high-water, seven-day activity spark, open and staged counts, link to the workstream context file. Replaces reading the board end-to-end to find out where Terra is.

6 · Pulse — the numbers the next volume quotes.

Decision latency (raised → decided, p50/p90), release latency, queue burn-down, staged-age histogram, verified-versus-claimed, sweeps per day, freshness history.

Plus global search and a quick-capture button: dictate a thought, file it to a matter — ten seconds, phone out to phone away.

SPEC 05 · CURSOR-READY

Sixteen days, five gates.

Next.js 15 · TypeScript · Tailwind + shadcn · Drizzle + SQLite · SSE · PWA. Repo FM1983/rook, private. Each phase ends usable, each gate is runnable – "looks good" is not a test.

THE PHASES

0 · Steel d1–2	Repo, tokens, schema, Tailscale serve, identity, health. Gate: the phone reaches /api/health over tailnet with identity; a non-tailnet request is impossible.
1 · Mirror d2–5	Importer + ingest; Today/Queue/Item/Matters read-only; SSE; PWA install. Gate: a red flag written by a live sweep appears on the phone in under 60 seconds. Usable from day five even if nothing else ships.
2 · Decide d5–8	Decide/defer/amend, quick capture, offline queue, decisions egested to Dropbox, one doctrine page so sweeps ingest rulings. Gate: decide offline in a lift; reconnect; the .md is in Dropbox and the next sweep reflects it.
3 · Dispatch d8–12	Staging, tokened release, agent inbox/ack loop, draft + Telegram channels, aging nags, T-48/24/3 escalations. Gate: a test agent acks by file and the state flips on the phone; a stale staged item has nagged exactly once a day.
4 · Prove d12–16	Verify flow with proof refs, Pulse metrics, ledger mirror, cross-alarming watchdogs, role scoping. Gate: the 30-day parallel run starts; a deliberately-killed daemon is alarmed within ten minutes.

SECURITY — THE RESTRICTED-CLAIMS ANNEX

Tailnet-only, loopback bind, ts.net TLS. Privileged matters excluded **at the query layer**, not the UI. No secrets in the repo – the service-account key stays where it lives today, never in Dropbox. The event ledger is immutable. Forbidden in v1: Funnel or any public exposure, autonomous sending, privileged documents in the app database, and any LLM call from inside Rook.

DEFINITION OF DONE

FM clears real board items from the phone for a full week; at least 80% of that week's decisions exist in Rook *before* any sweep infers them; zero staged items silently older than 72 hours; and the next Pulse report draws its decision-latency numbers from the app instead of grepping BOARD.md.

Design: bone paper, ink, Citadel green as the only accent, rust for criticals; Archivo with tabular numerals; Fraunces for the wordmark alone. Tokens shipped as a file and consumed literally — "design token files are not guidelines; they are literal input."

ROOK

Build specification v1.0 — the Citadel board console. The operative artifact is SPEC.md in the repository; this document is its typeset twin for review.

Written against the live record: the audit's decision-object and material-decision-gate findings, the five-field proof pilot, the release-discipline failures of August, the launchd outage, and the local-only serving doctrine. Open items are four and none block Phase 0: escalation channel default, a possible calendar-first view for Nicki, importer fingerprinting against known id collisions, and a deliberately-deferred counsel read-only view.

ISSUE	REPO	BUILD IN	IMPRINT
Spec v1.0	FM1983 / rook	Cursor · 5 phases	Citadel · Lightspeed